

CURRENT AFFAIRS



NEWS ANALYSIS

11th WEEK

2016



UPSC

14th Mar to 20th Mar

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**NEW ERA IN
MYANMAR**



THIS WEEK ... WE DELIBERATE ON THE ISSUE

**CAN AUNG SAN SUU KYI
BREAK THE
STRANGLEHOLD OF
MILITARY?**



AUNG SAN SUU KYI BECAME THE WINNER IN ELECTIONS HELD IN NOVEMBER 2015

FACT FILE ON MYANMAR

- *Region* ... SE Asia
- *Population* ... 53.26 million
- *Religion* ... Buddhism
- *Capital* ... Naypyidaw
- *Currency* ... Burmese kyat
- *Voters* ... 30 million
- *Seats* ... 664
- *% of voting* ... 80
- *Elections conducted in 1 day*
- *Total parties* ... 90



Aung San Suu Kyi

National League for Democracy (NLD)

- Aung San Suu Kyi won the First **Free General Elections** in 25 years by winning **77% of the elected seats. 25% of the seats are reserved for military.**
- **Union Solidarity and Development Party (USDP)** is **badly defeated** including its Chief Htay Oo.



LOOK AT THE PARLIAMENT

TOTAL SEATS OF PARLIAMENT ... 664



UPPER HOUSE

Total seats ... 224
Reserved for military... 56 (25%)



LOWER HOUSE

Total seats ... 440
Reserved for military ... 110 (25%)

MYANMAR...

A GLANCE AT THE STATE OF AFFAIRS



1 The Constitution was drafted by the military

2 Article 59F says anyone with foreign children is ineligible to become President

3 25% of the seats in Parliament reserved for military (unelected armed forces)

4 Commander-in-Chief will nominate the heads of three powerful Ministries viz., Home Affairs, Defence & Border Affairs.

MYANMAR...

A SLIGHT IMPROVEMENT SINCE 2010



Formation of quasi-civilian Government and beginning of minor-reforms	End of Suu Kyi's house arrest
Release of several political prisoners	Easing of restrictions on media
Allowed formation of labour unions	Opening of some sectors, such as telecom, to foreign investments



Aung San Suu Kyi

Real Head of Government,
Leader of National
League for Democracy



Htin Kyaw

President,
but real power lies with
Aung San Suu Kyi



MAJOR CHALLENGES

1

Because of military rule since 1962, the country is isolated and underdeveloped and one of the poorest nations in Asia. socio-economic schemes reach only 3% of the population.
How to bring millions out of poverty is the real challenge!

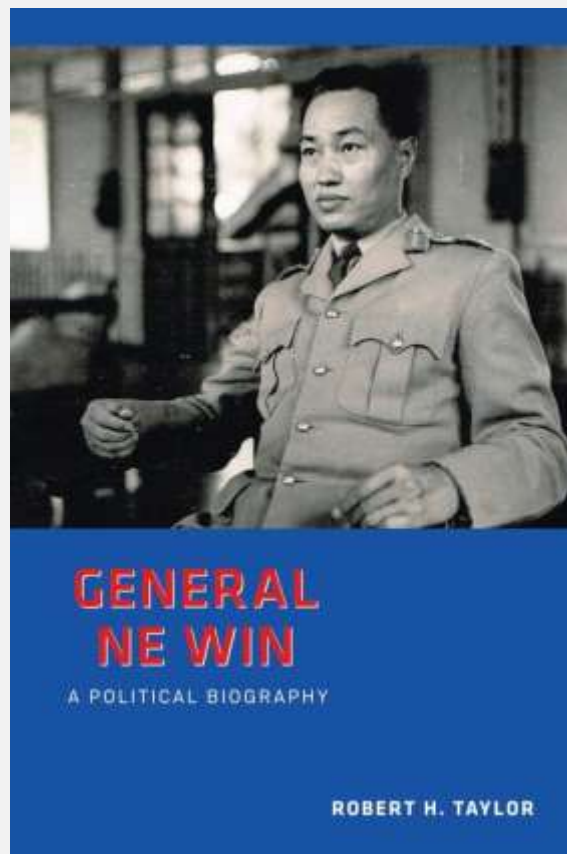


Ne Win : 1911-2002

- Ne Win was a Burmese politician and military commander.
- He was Prime Minister of Burma from 1958 to 1960 and 1962 to 1974.
- He was the Head of the State from 1962 to 1981.
- He was the military leader of Burma for 26 years.



Ne Win meets Soviet politicians



MAJOR CHALLENGES

2

Destruction of Forests (Myanmar has the third highest rate of deforestation in the world), poor industrialization, poor infrastructure in rural hinterland, HDI rank at around 150 indicate herculean task ahead for Aung San Suu Kyi.



MAJOR CHALLENGES

3

Military controls 25% of the seats in Parliament. Constitutional amendment requires more than 75% of votes in Parliament. Hence major legislations through constitutional amendments are ruled out without military support.



MAJOR CHALLENGES

4

Military (Tatmadaw) became successful to elect one of its retired Generals, Myint Swe, as Vice President. This shows the intention of the military to cling on to power. As per the already laid down rules, military also nominates three most important Ministers : Defence, Home Affairs & Border Affairs. Can transition to democracy take place under these circumstances?



NEW ERA IN MYANMAR

MAJOR CHALLENGES

5

Aung San Suu Kyi has got high reputation across the World. Though, she will be the real head of Government, technically, Htin Kyaw will be the President. Now, the question is, whether she can influence the World leaders and represent in World Summits / Forums?



MAJOR CHALLENGES

6

Can this arrangement of Aung San Suu Kyi – Htin Kyaw be successful in the long run?



**Aung San Suu Kyi &
Htin Kyaw**



**Sonia Gandhi &
Manmohan Singh**

MAJOR CHALLENGES

7

There are several ethnic groups like Wa and Kachin in Myanmar fighting the Govt. Some of these armed ethnic groups are allegedly supported by China. Can the new Govt. tackle the legacy of half a century of civil wars in ethnic minority borderlands?



MAJOR CHALLENGES

8

What is going to be the plight of Rohingya Muslims? Can Aung San Suu Kyi do justice to Rohingya Muslims?



INDIA – MYANMAR IN SPOTLIGHT

1

Several insurgency groups have got bases in Myanmar. Can Myanmar undertake 1995 like operation (Operation Golden Bird) to destroy base camps of terrorist organisations of the North East?



INDIA – MYANMAR IN SPOTLIGHT

2

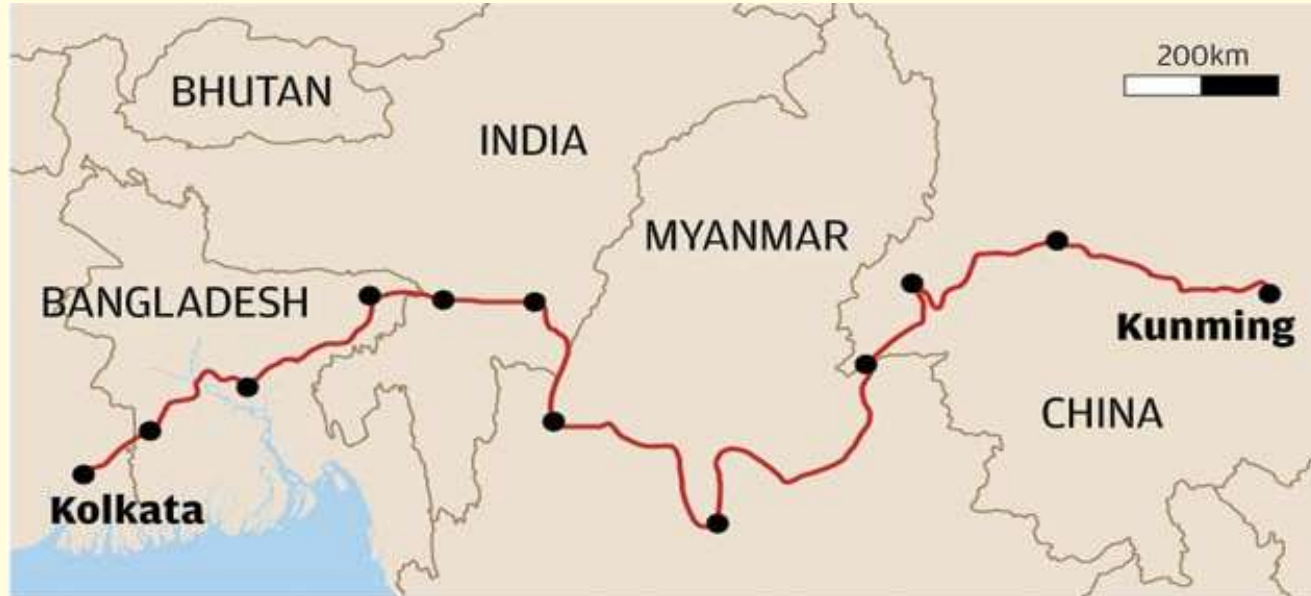
India can contribute a lot for development of Myanmar, especially in ICT sphere. Can Myanmar take the expertise available in India?



INDIA – MYANMAR IN SPOTLIGHT

3

Can the Bangladesh, China, India and Myanmar (BCIM) Economic Corridor become a reality, which will facilitate greater integration of trade and investment in the region?



INDIA – MYANMAR IN SPOTLIGHT

4

Can it expedite the planned trilateral highway between India-Myanmar-Thailand, which connects Moreh in India with Mae Sot in Thailand?



INDIA – MYANMAR IN SPOTLIGHT

5

Does it lead to more technological and economic cooperation as envisaged in Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi- Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC) Agreement?



Bangladesh



Bhutan



India



Myanmar



Nepal



Sri Lanka



Thailand

**LET US WISH
AUNG SAN SUU KYI
ALL THE BEST TO
OVERCOME THESE
CHALLENGES !**



LEARNING SPACE
...Transforming Human Lives